

Recruitment pre-survey — lean persuasion experiment

The Global Climate Scheme (GCS) and global redistribution:
a nationally representative online survey in China
Instrument v3 (lean fielding version)

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What this is. A lean fielding version of the full Track B instrument (`questionnaire.tex` v2, 13 July 2026, 20–24 min), targeting 12–14 minutes. It does three jobs at once:

1. **Recruitment funnel** for the Track A audio interviews (Module 0, placed *before* quota screening, per Adrien’s French recruitment questionnaire);
2. **Baseline measurement**: it obtains each volunteer’s GCS support before the interview, which is what makes the within-person “survey attitude → post-interview attitude” comparison possible (Adrien: this is the primary purpose of a pre-survey);
3. **A publishable lean experiment**: a six-cell between-subjects persuasion experiment including one arm that is only possible in China.

Differences from v2. The conjoint module and the behavioural-proxy module are dropped; the values battery is cut from nine items to five; demographics keep only what quotas and self-interest exposure require. The between-subjects cells are revised (see Module 5): a **personalised economic-impact arm** replaces P10 (“boosts the global economy”), and the C8 historical-responsibility rewrite is folded into T3. The proposal text (Q4.0) and all argument texts are **verbatim identical** to the interview script `cs_interview_script_zh.md` — this is the foundation of the Track A / Track B docking.

Blocking prerequisite: [TBD: DECIDE 9: X / Y / Z and the sign, from Adrien’s GCS model]. Needed in Q4.0, T1 and T2. The survey cannot go to field before it arrives.

Module 0 — Interview opt-in (Track A recruitment)

[Programming note: First screen, before quota screening, so that everyone who starts answers it, including people later screened out on full quotas. French funnel for reference: 3,500 starts / 1,000 completes / 380 left an email / 66 showed up.]

Q0.1 One purpose of this questionnaire is to recruit participants for an academic study. The interview is one-to-one with a researcher, on your concerns in life and your values, conducted **by voice call (no camera)**, lasting about 45 minutes, and is paid ([TBD: amount; parent project pays EUR 10 /

45 min]). Would you be interested in taking part?

- Yes. Please leave your WeChat ID so we can contact you: _____
- No

[Programming note: China adaptations relative to Adrien's original: WeChat ID rather than email; "video-conference" becomes "voice call". Booking runs through the panel provider or WeChat — email automation (Brevo) is unavailable in mainland China.]

Module 1 — Consent and quota screening

Q1.0 [Consent] Hello. We are a university research team running an academic study on economic life and views about public policy. The questionnaire takes about 13 minutes. Your answers will be used for academic research only and processed anonymously; we do not collect your name or any identity document, and data are stored on servers located in mainland China. Participation is entirely voluntary and you may withdraw at any time. Do you agree to begin?

- Agree, begin
- Do not agree (skip to end)

Q1.1–Q1.6 [Quota screening] Age band; gender; province of residence; urban/rural; household monthly income band (under 5,000 / 5,000–10,000 / 10,000–20,000 / 20,000–50,000 / above 50,000 RMB); highest education.

*[Programming note: Hard quotas on age $\times$ gender $\times$ region $\times$ urban/rural $\times$ income $\times$ education, benchmarked to the national online adult population, reusing the team's 2024 redistribution survey targets: seven regions (North 12%, Northeast 7%, East 30%, Central 16%, South 13%, Southwest 15%, Northwest 7%); urban/rural 64/36; age 18–35: 40%, 35–50: 40%, 50+: 20%; gender balanced. People screened out on full quotas still have a valid Q0.1 sign-up — that is the entire point of front-loading the opt-in. **Education is a quota, not an exclusion** (a screen on education was proposed in September 2026 and is not adopted: the FR/IT/UK legs used general-population panels, screening on education would damage cross-country comparability, and education is itself a core analysis covariate).]*

Module 2 — Demographics and self-interest exposure (lean)

Q2.1 [Place of residence] Big city / suburb of a big city / medium-sized city / town or small city / countryside

Q2.2 [Hukou] Agricultural / non-agricultural / unified resident hukou

Q2.3 [Employment] Working (incl. farming) / retired and working / retired not working / not retired and not working / student

Q2.4 [Household size] How many people live in your household? How many are adults aged 18 or over?

Q2.5 [Self-interest: transport] Does your household own a car? How often do you drive? (daily / several times a week / occasionally / never)

Q2.6 [Self-interest: heating] What is your household's main source of winter heating? (district heating / gas / coal / electricity / other / none)

Q2.7 [Self-interest: air travel] Have you flown in the past year? How many times?

[Programming note: Q2.4–Q2.7 plus the income band from Q1.5 are the inputs to the T2 personalisation algorithm. If T2 is dropped because DECIDE 9 does not arrive, Q2.7 can be dropped too.]

Module 3 — Pre-treatment attitudes and values

[Programming note: Everything here precedes treatment, so covariates cannot be contaminated, and attriters still leave a complete covariate record.]

Q3.1 [Climate concern] How serious a problem do you think climate change is? (0 = not serious at all, 10 = extremely serious)

Q3.2 [Self-assessed climate knowledge] How much do you feel you know about climate change? (1 = almost nothing, 5 = a great deal)

[Programming note: This also answers the “concept familiarity” concern raised by Maoliang Ye (13 July 2026): we neither screen on it nor explain the concept, we measure it and condition on it — consistent with the interview side.]

Q3.3 [Purchasing power] Are you satisfied with your purchasing power? (1 = very dissatisfied, 5 = very satisfied)

[Programming note: Same item as interview Clip 2, so the two instruments dock directly.]

Q3.4 [Economic anxiety] Are you worried that your household income will fall over the coming year? (1 = not at all, 5 = very worried)

Q3.5 [Global redistribution, pre-treatment] Global redistribution refers to the government-led transfer of wealth from rich countries and rich people to poor countries and poor people on an international scale. Overall, do you support or oppose global redistribution in that sense? (0–10)

[Programming note: Matches interview Clip 12. Asked of everyone regardless of R1: it carries no information about the GCS proposal, so it does not anchor the GCS support item.]

Values battery (0–10 agreement; item order randomised across respondents): **Q3.6** It is the government’s responsibility to reduce the income gap between rich and poor.

Q3.7 In the society I live in today, success is largely determined by luck and background rather than by individual effort or talent.

Q3.8 When individual and collective interests conflict, we should always put collective interests first.

Q3.9 Western countries seek to exploit China.

Q3.10 China is better than most other countries.

[Programming note: Items taken verbatim from the team’s meritocracy survey and 2024 redistribution survey, for comparability with our own historical data. Q3.9–Q3.10 are the key moderators for T3 (fairness / common but differentiated responsibilities). Note that these two items prime the whole sample in the same direction; since exposure is identical across arms this does not threaten the internal validity of the ATE, but it may shift the overall level of persuasion effects. The v2 social-values items (gender, sexual minorities) and life-satisfaction items are dropped in this lean version.]



Module 4 — GCS proposal and comprehension check

Q4.0 [Proposal text — shown to all respondents, verbatim, identical to interview Clip 15]

In 2015, all countries agreed to contain global warming “well below +2°C”. To achieve this, there is a maximum amount of greenhouse gases we can emit globally.

To meet the climate target, a limited number of permits to emit greenhouse gases would be issued globally. Polluting firms would be required to buy permits to cover their greenhouse gas emissions. Such a policy would make fossil fuel companies pay for their emissions and gradually raise the price of fossil fuels. Higher prices would encourage people and companies to use less fossil fuels, reducing greenhouse gas emissions.



In accordance with the principle that each human has an equal right to pollute, the revenues generated by the sale of permits could finance a global basic income. Every adult would receive [TBD: X RMB] per month, thereby lifting 600 million people who earn less than 2 dollars a day out of extreme poverty.

The typical Chinese resident would [TBD: lose / gain] financially about [TBD: Y RMB] per month, as he or she would face around [TBD: Z%] in price increases, which is [TBD: higher / lower] than the [TBD: X RMB] per month they would receive.

The policy could be implemented as soon as 100 countries agree to it. Countries that would refuse to take part could face sanctions (like tariffs) from the rest of the world and would be excluded from the basic income program.

[Programming note: X, Y, Z come from the same GCS-model calibration as interview Clip 15 (DECIDE 9); the sign itself is unconfirmed — China may be a net winner. If China is a net winner, this paragraph reverses the situation faced in the US, UK, FR and IT legs, which is the main theoretical selling point of the China leg.]

Q4.1 [Comprehension] According to the description above, which of the following is correct?

- Under the scheme, permit revenues would fund a basic income for every adult (correct)
- The scheme would apply only in developed countries
- The scheme places no cap on firms' emissions
- Don't know



[Programming note: Wrong answers trigger one gentle correction and a re-display of the key points; nobody is excluded for failing (this avoids selective attrition). The PAP defines a robustness sample of respondents who pass.]

Q4.2 [Pre-treatment support — “twice-measured” group only, randomisation factor R1, probability 1/3] Do you support this Global Climate Scheme? (0–10; 0 = fully oppose, 5 = indifferent, 10 = fully support). Follow-up: how certain are you about that answer? (0–10)



[Programming note: R1 is orthogonal to the treatment arms: 1/3 answer support twice (here and in Module 6), 2/3 answer only post-treatment. The split follows Adrien's 6 July 2026 proposal (about 1,000 twice / 2,000 once) and makes the anchoring effect of pre-measurement itself estimable. Item order matters: the pre-measure must come after the proposal text and before treatment.]

Module 5 — Between-subjects treatment (randomisation factor R2)

[Programming note: Equal allocation across six cells; at $N = 3,000$ that is about 500 per cell. Argument texts are the China-adapted versions from the interview script, verbatim. Display format: “Some people make the following argument about this scheme. Please read it:” + argument text + “In your own words, do you think this argument has merit?” (open text, one sentence is enough — this ensures the treatment is actually read and produces text data comparable with the interview transcripts).]

Cell	Argument	Mechanism	Direction
C	Pure control: no argument shown	—	—
T1	C11 + C5: raises fuel prices, hurts purchasing power; most Chinese lose	Self-interest	Counter
T2	Personalised economic-impact feedback (below)	Self-interest	Individual
T3	P4 + C8-CN: polluter pays; common but differentiated responsibilities	Fairness	Pro
T4	P2: the scheme would reduce poverty worldwide	Humanitarian	Pro
T5	P1 + P9: it would end climate change; it does not require every country	Efficacy	Pro

T2 template [Personalised economic impact] Based on the household income, household size, car use and heating that you reported, our research team’s economic model estimates that under this scheme your household would [TBD: gain / lose] about [TBD: ____ RMB] per month. In China, about [TBD: ____%] of residents would be net winners financially.

[Programming note: T2 is the main addition relative to v2. It follows the personalised-gain information experiments in Douenne & Fabre (2020, 2022) and Dechezleprêtre et al. (2025) (PDFs in Literature/Fabre/). It isolates self-interest cleanly from the other mechanisms, and if most Chinese residents are net winners this arm is simply not available in the Western legs — an independent contribution of the China leg. It **depends entirely on DECIDE 9**: without the model there is no algorithm, and the fallback is to drop T2 and field five cells. Note that T2 does not contradict the “typical Chinese resident” sentence in Q4.0: that is a national average, whereas T2 is an estimate for this respondent — it is incremental information.]

[Programming note: The C8-CN wording is [TBD: DECIDE 6] and must match Section 4 of the interview script verbatim.]

Module 6 — Post-treatment outcomes

Q6.1 [GCS support, primary outcome] Do you support the Global Climate Scheme? Please respond with a number from 0 to 10, where 0 means you fully oppose it, 5 means you are indifferent, and 10 means you fully support it.

[Programming note: Verbatim aligned with interview Clip 16 and Adrien’s cross-country surveys ([TBD: DECIDE 9: obtain his exact item wording]). Primary analysis: full sample $N = 3,000$, post-treatment outcome, pre-registered covariates (Modules 2–3) and quota-stratum fixed effects. Secondary: ANCOVA and change scores within the R1 twice-measured group.]

Q6.2 [Certainty] How certain are you about that answer? (0–10)

Q6.3 [Global redistribution, post-treatment] (same wording as Q3.5, 0–10)



Q6.4 [Second-order belief] Out of 100 Chinese people, how many do you think would support this scheme? (0–100)

[Programming note: Q6.4 addresses the “Chinese support looks implausibly high” puzzle by separating a respondent’s own stated position from their beliefs about others, giving a first cut at distinguishing genuine support from acquiescence (preference falsification: Kuran; Jiang & Yang; Cantoni et al.). It costs one item. A full list experiment is [TBD: optional, subject to panel-provider feasibility] and is not included in this lean version.]

Q6.5 [Optional, open text] What do you think is the biggest problem with this scheme? (one or two sentences)

[Programming note: Mirrors the pros-and-cons stage of the interview, and provides large-N material for validating the Track A coding scheme.]



Module 7 — Debrief and second opt-in

Q7.1 [Debrief] Thank you for taking part. The argument shown to you was drawn at random from a set of arguments for and against; it does not reflect the research team’s position, and different respondents saw different arguments. The scheme is a policy proposal discussed in academic research. If you have questions about the study you may contact [TBD: contact details].

Q7.2 [Second opt-in — only for respondents who answered “No” to Q0.1] If you have changed your mind, you are still welcome to take part in the paid voice interview mentioned earlier. Would you like to leave a WeChat ID?

[Programming note: About 11% of starters left contact details in Adrien’s French funnel; a second ask at the end is a cheap increment.]

Appendix A — Sample and power

Target: 3,000 completes (analysis floor 2,500). Extrapolating linearly from Adrien’s French funnel (3,500 starts / 1,000 completes / 380 contacts / 66 attended), 3,000 completes requires roughly 10,500 starts and yields about 1,150 volunteers and about 200 interviews — more than the 100–200 Track A needs. **Note** that the binding constraint is starts and quotas, not completes.

Minimum detectable effects (two-sided 5%, power 80%, baseline SD 2.8)

Analysis sample	n per cell	Estimator	MDE
Full sample (post + covariates, $R^2 \approx 0.3$)	500	Difference in means	0.41 pts ($\approx 0.15\sigma$)
R1 twice-measured group ($\rho \approx 0.65$)	167	ANCOVA	0.65 pts ($\approx 0.23\sigma$)
Pooled (pre-registered primary)	500	Covariate-adjusted	0.41 pts ($\approx 0.15\sigma$)

[Programming note: Read: the headline rests on the full sample; the twice-measured group exists to estimate the anchoring effect and to supply within-person change, not to carry power. Dropping T2 back to five cells gives 600 per cell and an MDE of about 0.37 points.]

Appendix B — What must be settled before fielding

1. [TBD: DECIDE 9] X / Y / Z and the sign, from Adrien's GCS model. Blocks Q4.0, T1, T2 and interview Clip 15. **The only true blocker.**
2. [TBD: DECIDE 6] Final wording of the C8-CN "common but differentiated responsibilities" rewrite, verbatim-matched to Section 4 of the interview script.
3. [TBD: DECIDE 9b] Exact wording of Q6.1 / Q6.2 / Q3.5 from Adrien, for verbatim alignment with his cross-country surveys.
4. Panel provider, quota targets, cost per complete and budget (Maoliang Ye).
5. Incentive amount and payment channel (WeChat / Alipay / JD e-card).
6. Ethics approval (Track B sits at SUSTech) and mainland data residency.
7. Pre-registration: AEA RCT Registry entry plus an OSF pre-analysis plan, filed before fielding.
8. When the full Track B instrument is fielded, [TBD: either exclude respondents to this survey or include them and control for prior exposure].